Practice workbook · Vigenere cipher

Encrypting or decrypting letters with a repeated keyword and a Vigenere square.

1 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 0 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: CSC-T3-19

1. Question 3 · part c · 4 marks

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Worked-example retry · Attempt part c only.

3 Several encryption algorithms have been developed.

(a) Ahmed has started to create a Caesar cipher encryption program.

Caesar cipher encryption works by giving a number value to a key.

Each letter in a plaintext message is replaced by a new ciphertext letter using the key.

For example, as shown in the table, a key value of +2 would change the plaintext message **encrypt** to the ciphertext message **gpetarv**.

Plaintext	e	n	c	r	y	p	t
Ciphertext	g	p	e	t	a	r	v

Ahmed's program already converts from plaintext to ciphertext.

He wants to extend the program to:

- accept the input of a plaintext message
- accept the input of the key, which must be a positive integer between 1 and 25
- write the generated ciphertext to a text file named **Cipher.txt**
- display the ciphertext.

Open **Q03a** in the code editor.

Complete the program code.

You must use the structure given in the file **Q03a** to complete the program.

Do not add any further functionality.

Save your code as **Q03aFINISHED** with the correct file extension for the programming language.

(8)

(b) Explain **one** reason why the Caesar cipher is a weak encryption algorithm.

(2)

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(c) The Vigenere cipher encrypts plaintext using a series of Caesar ciphers, based on the letters of a keyword and a Vigenere square.

Figure 1 shows a Vigenere square.

	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z
a	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z
b	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a
c	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b
d	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c
e	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d
f	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e
g	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f
h	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g
i	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h
j	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i
k	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j
l	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k
m	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l
n	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m
o	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n
p	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o
q	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p
r	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q
s	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r
t	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s
u	u	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t
v	v	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u
w	w	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v
x	x	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w
y	y	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x
z	z	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y

Figure 1

Complete the table to perform a Vigenere decryption of the ciphertext message **flmktrwhee** using the keyword **thirty**.

(4)

Encrypted letter	f	l	m	k	t	r	w	h	e	e
Keyword letter										
Decrypted letter										

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P 6 6 4 9 0 A 0 9 1 6

9

Turn over ▶

1. Question 3 · part c · 4 marks

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Worked-example retry · Attempt part c only.

(d) A user-defined function uses a Vigenere cipher to encrypt plaintext into ciphertext.

This pseudocode shows how the function is called.

```
SET ciphertext TO ciphertext & getCipherLetter(keywordLetter, plaintextLetter)
```

(i) State what would be returned by this function.

(1)

.....

.....

(ii) Give the name of **one** parameter passed to this function.

(1)

.....

(iii) State what is meant by a **built-in subprogram**.

(1)

.....

.....

(Total for Question 3 = 17 marks)

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1. Question 3 · part c · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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